

Daily Content Intel

August 28, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Cleared to play, sprinting full speed, and the hamstring he tore was still 5% smaller.

That's a new study on 79 NCAA Division 1 football players. Maximal sprints with sensors on them, then every single one through an MRI to measure actual hamstring volume.

The previously injured legs had about 5% less muscle in the biceps femoris. Both heads.

And here's the part that gets me. The sprint mechanics were the same. Joint angles, side to side, identical. You could film it and you'd never see it.

But the muscle itself was lengthening faster on the injured side, 3 to 5% faster, so that tissue is doing more work at higher speed with less muscle to do it with.

Which is probably a big reason hamstrings keep re-tearing.

Here's what I do with that. Getting cleared means you're allowed to sprint again. The rebuild takes longer than the clearance does. So I keep loading that hamstring long, RDLs and Nordics, I put real max velocity sprinting on the calendar, and I compare sides the whole way.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Cleared to play, sprinting full speed, and the hamstring he tore was still 5% smaller.

Spoken script (word for word):

Cleared to play, sprinting full speed, and the hamstring he tore was still 5% smaller.

That's a new study on 79 NCAA Division 1 football players. Maximal sprints with sensors on them, then every single one through an MRI to measure actual hamstring volume.

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Which is probably a big reason hamstrings keep re-tearing.

Here's what I do with that. Getting cleared means you're allowed to sprint again. The rebuild takes longer than the clearance does. So I keep loading that hamstring long, RDLs

and Nordics, I put real max velocity sprinting on the calendar, and I compare sides the whole way.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Cleared. Sprinting. Still 5% smaller.
- 0:08 79 NCAA D1 football players, sprints + MRI
- 0:18 5% less muscle in the previously injured biceps femoris
- 0:28 Sprint mechanics looked identical side to side
- 0:38 The muscle lengthened 3 to 5% faster on the injured side
- 0:50 More work, higher speed, less muscle to do it with
- 1:00 Clearance is permission. The rebuild takes longer.
- 1:10 Load it long. Sprint on a schedule. Compare sides.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

79 NCAA Division 1 football players got sprint testing plus MRI. The legs that had

torn a hamstring were still carrying about 5% less muscle in the biceps femoris.

Their sprint mechanics looked the same side to side. Joint angles, identical. You would not catch it on film.

What was different sat underneath: the muscle was lengthening 3 to 5% faster on the injured side. More work, at higher speed, with less muscle available to absorb it.

That gap is a big part of why hamstrings keep re-tearing.

Getting cleared means you are allowed to sprint again. The rebuild takes longer than the clearance does. So I keep loading the hamstring at long lengths, I put real max velocity sprinting on the calendar, and I compare sides the whole way through.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
threshold.clientsecure.me

#hamstring #footballtraining #returntosport
#speedtraining #sportsrehab
#strengthandconditioning

#athletedevelopment #hsfootball
#sprintmechanics #physicaltherapy

Personalize this

- Which of your football or lacrosse athletes came back from a hamstring strain last season, and what did you actually keep loading after they were cleared? Name the exercise and the weeks, that specificity is the whole Reel.
- What is your own side-to-side check for a hamstring before you let someone open up at full speed? Single-leg bridge holds, hop testing, sprint exposure on the calendar, something else? Say the test out loud so people can copy it.
- Where does this sit in CROSS for you, and have you ever had an athlete who looked clean on film and still felt something was off on the injured side? That eye test versus MRI tension is the strongest personal beat available here.

Shoot notes:

- Shoot this one against a clean wall or a plain section of the gym, not the window

side. The brief's drop-off frames are all busy gym backgrounds with equipment and large windows pulling the eye off you.

- Frame tight, chest up, with your head near the top third. Two of the three drop-off frames had dead space above the head and a flat expression, so crop the ceiling out entirely.
- Start already talking with energy on "Cleared to play" and land "5% smaller" inside the first 3 seconds. No breath, no wind-up, no mid-sentence cold open.

Hook shape: Story hook. The brief's Skip rate by hook style puts the story hook at 60.9%, 3.2 points below your average and the only shape under it, and the payoff (5% smaller after clearance) sits in the opening line rather than after a setup.

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13248003/> | "Impact of Prior Hamstring Strain Injury on Muscle Morphology and Sprinting Biomechanics in Collegiate American Football Athletes"

- physiology | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13248003/> | "Although sprint kinematics were similar between limbs, those with prior HSI exhibited persistent BFIh and BFsh atrophy"
- actionable | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13248003/> | "could enhance rehabilitation monitoring and guide loading strategies to mitigate reinjury risk"

Sources:

- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13248003/>
- <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42261806/>

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Kid pulls a gripper out of his bag between sets, and he's training the one position his grip never fails in.

Okay, so a gripper trains a closed crush. Fingers curl toward the palm, the thumb does almost nothing, the wrist stays locked, and the tension peaks right where your hand is already strongest.

Now look at what your grip actually does on the field. A lineman holding a block is an open hand. A lacrosse player keeping his stick through a check is thumb and fingers with no crush at all. A heavy carry is support endurance. A row is a hook that slowly unrolls.

None of that looks like squeezing a spring.

And strength is really specific to the position you train it in. That part is settled, it's about the oldest principle in the field. How much one grip exercise carries over to another is honestly still thin research, so I'll hedge there.

I won't hedge on this. I'd rather my athletes spend those 8 minutes on fat grips for rows and curls, plate pinches, and open hand plate curls, and I'd try chalk before straps, because chalk fixes friction and straps outsource the whole link.

Train the hand positions where you actually lose the bar.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Kid pulls a gripper out of his bag between sets, and he's training the one position his grip never fails in.

Spoken script (word for word):

Kid pulls a gripper out of his bag between sets, and he's training the one position his grip never fails in.

Okay, so a gripper trains a closed crush. Fingers curl toward the palm, the thumb does almost nothing, the wrist stays locked, and the tension peaks right where your hand is already strongest.

Now look at what your grip actually does on the field. A lineman holding a block is an open hand. A lacrosse player keeping his stick through a check is thumb and fingers with no crush at all. A heavy carry is support endurance. A row is a hook that slowly unrolls.

None of that looks like squeezing a spring.

And strength is really specific to the position you train it in. That part is settled, it's about the oldest principle in the field. How much one grip exercise carries over to another is honestly still thin research, so I'll hedge there.

I won't hedge on this. I'd rather my athletes spend those 8 minutes on fat grips for rows

and curls, plate pinches, and open hand plate curls, and I'd try chalk before straps, because chalk fixes friction and straps outsource the whole link.

Train the hand positions where you actually lose the bar.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 The gripper trains the one position your grip never fails in
- 0:10 Closed crush: fingers to palm, thumb idle, wrist locked
- 0:22 Lineman on a block = open hand
- 0:28 Stick through a check = thumb and fingers
- 0:34 Heavy carry = support endurance
- 0:44 Strength is specific to the position you train
- 0:58 Evidence on carryover is thin. My opinion isn't.
- 1:08 Fat grips. Plate pinches. Open hand plate curls. Chalk first.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

The gripper in your gym bag trains a closed crush. Fingers curl toward the palm, the thumb barely works, the wrist stays locked, and tension peaks exactly where your hand is already strongest.

Then look at what a grip actually has to do in sport. A lineman holding a block is an open hand. A lacrosse player keeping his stick through a check is thumb and fingers with no crush at all. A heavy carry is support endurance. A row is a hook that slowly unrolls.

Strength is specific to the position you train it in. That principle is settled. How much any single grip exercise carries over to another is still thin research, so I will say that plainly.

What I will not hedge on is where I would spend the time: fat grips on rows and curls, plate pinches, open hand plate curls, 8 minutes at the end of a session. And chalk before straps, because chalk fixes a friction problem and straps hand off the whole link.

Train the hand positions where you actually lose the bar.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
threshold.clientsecure.me

#gripstrength #footballtraining #lacrosse
#strengthandconditioning
#athletedevelopment #forearms #hsfootball
#liftingtips #sportsperformance
#physicaltherapy

Personalize this

- Which of your football or lacrosse athletes has a grip that actually limits them, and where does it show up? Linemen losing a block late in a drive, a middie losing stick control on contact, someone whose rows die before their back does? One real name and one real moment carries this whole Reel.
- What grip work do you actually program, and when does it land in the session? If it's fat grips on accessory rows or plate pinches at the end, say the sets and the minutes so it's copyable.
- Where do you land on straps for a high school athlete? You have a strong

position here, and the chalk-before-straps call is the line people will argue with in the comments, so state it the way you'd state it in the gym.

Shoot notes:

- Hold something in frame while you talk: a plate for the pinch, a fat grip, chalk. Every drop-off frame in the brief was a talking head with nothing happening, so give the eye a prop instead of a busy background.
- Plain wall, tight crop, no ceiling. The flagged frames all had large empty wall or white ceiling eating the upper half.
- Bring visible energy on the first line and deliver "training the one position his grip never fails in" as a complete thought before you breathe. Do not start mid-sentence.

Hook shape: Story hook, chosen over the contrarian shape because the brief's Skip rate by hook style rates the contrarian hook at 65.5% (+1.4pp vs average) and the story hook at 60.9% (-3.2pp), and the claim itself sits in the opening line rather than trailing a setup.

Screenshots:

- title |
<https://www.strongerbyscience.com/grip/> |
"The Evidence-Based Guide to Grip Strength Training & Forearm Muscle Development"
- physiology |
<https://www.strongerbyscience.com/grip/> |
"A foundational principle of exercise science is that the adaptations that occur after a select type of training are specific to the particular demands imposed by that type of training."
- actionable |
<https://www.strongerbyscience.com/grip/> |
"To reap the greatest performance transfer to a particular type of grip, keep in mind that these lower specificity forms of training should be used to supplement your sport specific grip training rather than replace it."

Sources:

- <https://www.strongerbyscience.com/grip/>

- https://miketnelson.com/grip_strength_is_your_missing_component/

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Acute effect of increasing resistance training workload volume on muscle damage markers in heavy resistance-trained youth athletes (PMID 42043074): 18 male rugby league players, age 17.4, four-week maximal strength mesocycle. Good in-season vs offseason loading angle for HS football.
- Internal training load and sprint endurance/aerobic fitness in a 4-week off-season HIIT program, adolescent female football players (PMID 42436293): time at $\geq 90\%$ peak HR as the metric that tracked improvement.
- Under-fueling in adolescent athletes: energy intake flat from under-12s through 16-plus despite rising demands (PMC12430154). Strong parent-facing fueling Reel, hold for a day when the research lane is quiet.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest
newsletter_digest_2026-08-28.pdf (2 sources): Dr. Mercola (exercise adherence, mostly promo, skipped) and Mike T. Nelson, "Straps, Chalk, and Why Your Grippers Are Lying to You". The grip piece drove Draft B.
- PubMed via NCBI E-utilities: hamstring strain morphology/sprint biomechanics, adolescent in-season resistance training, grip strength specificity and transfer, youth energy availability.
- Surfaced and rejected on dedup: the NFL early-sport-specialization study (PMC12795778) was already cited 2026-06-30, inside the 90-day window. Swapped to the grip angle.
- Grip specificity/transfer literature on PubMed came back essentially empty, which matches Nelson's own read that the transfer data is thin. Draft B hedges accordingly.
- Unreachable / blocked: Wiley Online Library returned 403 for the hamstring paper (used the open-access PMC mirror

instead); pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov served a cookie-block page to direct fetch; strongerbyscience.com returned 403 to WebFetch but loads normally in a real browser, so its screenshot targets were verified against the live HTML.

- Screenshot targets for both drafts were verified verbatim against the live pages before saving. Note: PMC renders hyphens as Unicode non-breaking hyphens, so target strings were chosen hyphen-free.